



HOW TO PLAY

plan the month

Start Here: Planning a Month of Activities

Who this is for

Activity directors, life enrichment coordinators, and caregivers who need to plan and record activities for older adults. Everything here is undated, so one purchase works every month and every year. Print as many copies as you need.

How to use it

Start with the Monthly Activity Calendar and pencil in the anchors first: standing group activities, outings, birthdays, and visits. Fill the gaps from the idea banks. Use the Weekly Focus Planner for the detail of each week, and the Session Log to record what actually happened.

A note on pacing

Aim for variety rather than volume. A good month mixes movement, conversation, music, hands and quiet. Leave genuine gaps for rest and for the days when plans change, because they will.





CALENDAR

plan the month

Monthly Activity Calendar

Write the month at the top and the dates in the small boxes, then plan one activity per day. Undated on purpose, so you can reuse this page every month.

MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY	SUNDAY
—	—	—	—	—	—	—
—	—	—	—	—	—	—
—	—	—	—	—	—	—
—	—	—	—	—	—	—
—	—	—	—	—	—	—





CALENDAR

plan the month

Monthly Activity Calendar: Long Month

The same calendar with a sixth row, for months that spill over into an extra week.

MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY	SUNDAY
—	—	—	—	—	—	—
—	—	—	—	—	—	—
—	—	—	—	—	—	—
—	—	—	—	—	—	—
—	—	—	—	—	—	—
—	—	—	—	—	—	—





FILL IN

plan the month

Weekly Focus Planner

Plan one week at a time. Fill in what you can and leave the rest flexible.

WEEK OF

THEME OR FOCUS FOR THE WEEK

GROUP ACTIVITY, AND WHO LEADS IT

ONE TO ONE VISITS, AND WITH WHOM

MUSIC OR SINGING

MOVEMENT OR GENTLE EXERCISE

HANDS ON OR CREATIVE ACTIVITY

OUTING, VISITOR, OR SPECIAL EVENT

QUIET OPTION FOR A LOW ENERGY DAY

SUPPLIES TO GATHER AHEAD OF TIME





CHECKLIST

plan the month

Activity Ideas: Twenty Ways to Fill a Morning

A bank of low prep ideas for group or one to one time. Tick the ones you use so you can vary them next month.

Conversation and memory

- ☐ Reminiscence prompts about growing up
- ☐ Finish the familiar saying, read aloud
- ☐ Look through old photographs together
- ☐ Name something in a category, around the group
- ☐ This or that, favorites from the past
- ☐ Share a recipe everyone remembers

Music and movement

- ☐ Sing along to songs of their era
- ☐ Seated stretches, ten gentle minutes
- ☐ Pass the ball or balloon around the circle
- ☐ Guess the song, played on a speaker
- ☐ Slow dance or sway to a favorite song
- ☐ Walk the corridor or garden together

Hands and quiet

- ☐ Fold and sort laundry or towels
- ☐ Arrange flowers in a vase
- ☐ Simple baking or no bake treats
- ☐ Card making for a family member
- ☐ Sorting buttons, coins, or fabric by color
- ☐ Read a short story or poem aloud
- ☐ Water and tend the plants
- ☐ Look out the window and name what you see





CHECKLIST

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Activity Ideas: Twenty More, by Season and Mood

Ideas for particular days: the seasons, the quiet afternoons, and the days when energy is low.

By season

- ☐ Spring: plant seeds in a small pot
- ☐ Spring: sort and name garden flowers
- ☐ Summer: iced drinks and shade outside
- ☐ Summer: talk about holidays by the sea
- ☐ Autumn: sort leaves, nuts, and pinecones
- ☐ Autumn: apple tasting and harvest talk
- ☐ Winter: hot drinks and warm blankets
- ☐ Winter: holiday traditions from their youth

For low energy days

- ☐ Hand massage with warm lotion
- ☐ Listen to a favorite album, no task
- ☐ Sit outside and feel the weather
- ☐ One photograph, one question, no rush
- ☐ Warm towel and a quiet chat

For a lively group

- ☐ Trivia in teams, gentle questions
- ☐ Bingo with a small prize
- ☐ Indoor bowling or ring toss
- ☐ Guess the object in the bag
- ☐ A sing along with requests
- ☐ Group storytelling, one line each





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Session Log

Record what actually happened. Over a few weeks this becomes the most useful page in the pack, because it shows you what works.

DATE AND TIME

.....

ACTIVITY WE DID

.....

WHO JOINED IN

.....

WHAT WENT WELL

.....

WHAT I WOULD CHANGE

.....

SOMEONE TO FOLLOW UP WITH

.....

IDEA THIS GAVE ME FOR NEXT TIME

.....





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Planning Tips That Save Time

Plan the anchors first

Put the fixed things on the calendar before anything else: standing groups, visits, birthdays, appointments, and outings. The gaps that remain are the only ones you actually need to fill, which is a much smaller job than planning a blank month.

Repeat what works

A favorite activity does not stop being a favorite. Once the Session Log shows something landed well, put it on the calendar again in two or three weeks. Familiarity is a feature, not a lack of imagination.

Always have a quiet option

Keep one low demand activity ready for every day, for the times when energy is low or a plan falls through. A warm drink and a photograph is a complete activity when that is what the day allows.

